

Weekly Writing - Week 1

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Should we as young inquisitive students learn how to code in R, or would we be better off letting AI & GPT's complete it for us?

Economists, data scientists and social scientists very often face tough questions, those of which require not only robust skills but also a curious nature. Both of these qualities are imperative in our journeys as aspiring economists, data scientists and social scientists in EC 242 and university as a whole. In order to work towards our aspirations, be able to answer these tough questions and further feed our curiosity while building hard skills, in EC 242 we should learn how to code in R. The most important aspect when tackling a question is not the answer but the process taken in search of it, and understanding how the process of executing these methods in R works is exactly what we should be doing as students - combining interdisciplinary skills such as economics and coding in the search for an answer to a question. The world, however, is in fact trending in the direction of higher AI usage and as students of economics we are ever looking to improve or efficiency. This is exactly what AI does and is incredibly important for us to understand how to leverage, However, understanding the mechanics of coding, data storage and manipulation is even more rewarding in terms of pushing our curiosity and establishing hard skills.